

Ryder Mawby

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RESEARCH

Digital Illicit Trade and the Geography of Retail Drug Markets

2025 - Present

MA Thesis · CSULB · Working paper, May 2026

- **Distance elasticity** ≈ -2.05 (PPML, pooled baseline) — substantially larger than the canonical licit-goods range, consistent with added enforcement deterrence on illegal international shipments.
- **Negative facilitation coefficients** — contiguity, common language, and colonial ties all suppress bilateral drug trade, the inverse of every licit-goods gravity study. Extensive–intensive margin decomposition locates effects entirely in the intensive margin.
- **MLAT mechanism test** — US mutual legal assistance treaty coverage independently suppresses conditional trade volume (-2.310^{***}), directly implicating institutional enforcement coordination.
- 354,212 cleaned listing-level observations from 10 cryptomarkets (2014–2022). Data obtained via direct correspondence with Nicolas Christin (CMU), David Décary-Héту (UdeM), and Judith Aldridge (Manchester).
- 8-stage multilingual classification pipeline in Stata — 57-category pharmacological taxonomy across English, German, Dutch, Finnish, and French. Replication code public at github.com/ryder-mawby/darknet-gravity-model.

EU Membership and Bilateral Trade: Evidence from Structural Gravity

March 2026

Seminar in International Trade & Development · CSULB

- PPML with three-way fixed effects (CEPII Gravity Database, 1990–2019, 962,373 obs). EU membership increases bilateral trade ~12%, robust to source and RTA controls.

Labor Supply Responses to California's Proposition 22

March 2026

Applied Econometrics · CSULB · Co-authored with Venus Versher

- Difference-in-differences with CPS microdata (Jan 2018–Dec 2025, individual-level panel, 2-way FE). ~11% post-passage decline in gig-worker self-employment, significant at 5%.

EDUCATION

California State University, Long Beach

Expected Dec. 2026

M.A. in Economics · Dean's List, Fall 2025

Econometrics I & II · Advanced Micro & Macro · Seminar in International Trade & Development · Applied Econometrics

University of California, Berkeley

May 2023

B.A. in Political Economy · GPA 3.6 · Regents' and Chancellor's Scholar

Concentration: Eastern European Political Economy · Russian language study · Opinion Columnist, The Daily Californian

EXPERIENCE

California State University, Long Beach

Aug. 2025 - Present

Graduate Assistant (ECON 100) & Teaching Associate (ECON 380) · Long Beach, CA

- Teach regression analysis, hypothesis testing, and statistical inference to 60+ undergraduates across two concurrent sections.

- Build course datasets and demonstrations in R, Stata, and Excel.

The New York Times

Oct. 2022 - Apr. 2024

Customer Support & Service Quality Specialist · Remote

- Analyzed subscriber support data to identify systemic issues; process improvements reduced recurring support tickets by ~75%.
- Maintained top Customer Effort Score company-wide across phone, email, chat, and social.

UC Berkeley — College of Letters & Science

Aug. 2022 - Nov. 2023

Research Assistant · Berkeley, CA

- Built alumni network for the Departments of Political Economy and Economics under supervision of Alan Karras.

SKILLS & CREDENTIALS

Software	Stata (ppmlhdf, reghdfe) · R · Python
Methods	PPML gravity · panel data · DiD · IV · event-study · large-scale dataset curation
Languages	Russian (working) · Spanish (working) · French (working)
Credentials	FINRA SIE (active Nov. 2028) · U.S. citizen